in Latin America, Asia and Africa. The thousands of letters from school children in the GDR have been tremendously moving."[56] Davis demonstrates the power of this volume and the movement around her trial to organize across boundaries, including East Germany and other places with walls and physical landscapes of division. Through this period of her detention and trial, walls enter Davis's lexicon, ahead of her autobiography's highlighting of the structure as one of its central symbols.[57]

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On June 4, 1972, Davis was acquitted on all charges. Outside the courthouse in Santa Clara County, California, a collective gathered to support Davis: she was joined by her lawyers, family members, and other supporters from her defense committee. Davis's sister, Fania Jordan, who served as the national coordinator of the committee, read a prepared statement: "The acquittal of Angela Davis is a sweet victory for the millions of us across the earth who have supported this long and difficult fight." Jordan also referenced the immense challenges, including the construction of "a $750,000 'security network' … quickly erected [outside the courthouse] to create a climate of fear and danger—and to influence potential jurors."[58] Jordan also took this time to mention the group's continuing work advocating for those who faced repression behind prison walls and outside in the larger struggle for black liberation.

That summer the autobiography began to take shape. Amid continued public interest and scrutiny over her case, Davis's camp fielded offers from publishers.[59] Toni Morrison, who had visited Davis in prison in Marin County, met with Aptheker for lunch to discuss "her preliminary thoughts on the type of book Angela Davis might do." According to a letter in response, addressed to Aptheker on June 27, 1972, Morrison suggested a framing that included short vignettes leading up to an extended section on the political history of the United States, a book that was meant to be a transcendent artifact of struggle. "A series of pieces on her recent experiences in the arms of American 'justice'—subjective in approach and perception … the book would be personal and political (there [is] no difference anyway) but the tone would meet the requirements of each encounter, event, or reflection. The book, like its author would be both the theory and the thing, the idea *and* its manifestation. It would be so powerful—it boggles the mind. It would [be] a non-book in the truest sense—that is to say—it would never be